



Data Day 2027 — Program & Schedule (DRAFT)

Theme: Five Years Forward — *Shaping what's next for Central Ohio's data community* **Event:** Data Day 2027 — 5th annual **Date:** Tuesday, February 16, 2027 **Venue:** OSU Vitria on the Square, 14 E. 15th Ave., Columbus, OH 43201 **Window:** 8:00 AM – 4:00 PM (program content ~8:45 AM – 3:35 PM)

Status: **Working draft for discussion.** Layout decisions resolved; remaining venue confirmations noted at the bottom.

Rooms & capacities

The four rooms are **fixed for the whole conference** — the Grand Ballroom divider stays in place all day, so every room is available continuously with no reconfiguration. The **Grand Ballroom is set in banquet rounds the entire day** (full rounds): keynotes, ballroom breakouts, the Intern Showcase, and lunch all run from the same round-table setup, so there is never a seating flip.

Room	Capacity	Role in the program
Grand Ballroom	250	Plenary, both keynotes, Intern Showcase; lecture + panel breakouts
Grand Ballroom B	70	Technical workshop sessions (hands-on)
Terrace A	100	Standard lecture breakouts
Terrace B	60	Standard lecture breakouts

Non-session spaces (active all day): the **Gallery** hosts **vendor & organization tabling**, and **poster presentations** are displayed throughout the venue's circulation areas. These run continuously and are not scheduled as sessions — see *Throughout the day* below.

Session types

Type	Length	Room(s)	Notes
Keynote	45–50 min	Grand Ballroom	Morning + lunch
Lecture	45 min	Grand Ballroom, Terrace A, Terrace B	Standard breakout
Panel	45 min	Grand Ballroom	Moderated, multi-speaker
Workshop	90 min	Grand Ballroom B	Hands-on/technical; spans 2 breakout blocks
Lightning / Intern Showcase	~5–7 min each	Grand Ballroom	Plenary, during lunch

Schedule

Time	Grand Ballroom (250)	Grand Ballroom B (70)	Terrace A (100)	Terrace B (60)
8:00–8:45	Registration & coffee	—	—	—
8:45–9:00	Welcome & opening (plenary)	—	—	—
9:00–9:50	Morning Keynote	—	—	—
9:50–10:05	<i>Break / transition</i>			
10:05–10:50	Block 1 — Lecture/Panel	Workshop A (90 min, → 11:50)	Block 1 — Lecture	Block 1 — Lecture
10:50–11:05	<i>Break</i>	<i>(workshop continues)</i>	<i>Break</i>	<i>Break</i>
11:05–11:50	Block 2 — Lecture/Panel	Workshop A (cont.)	Block 2 — Lecture	Block 2 — Lecture
11:50–12:05	<i>Break / transition to lunch</i>			
12:05–1:35	Lunch + Intern Showcase + Lunch Keynote + thank-yous/extras (plenary)	—	—	—
1:35–1:50	<i>Break / transition</i>			
1:50–2:35	Block 3 — Lecture/Panel	Workshop B (90 min, → 3:35)	Block 3 — Lecture	Block 3 — Lecture
2:35–2:50	<i>Break</i>	<i>(workshop continues)</i>	<i>Break</i>	<i>Break</i>
2:50–3:35	Block 4 — Lecture/Panel	Workshop B (cont.)	Block 4 — Lecture	Block 4 — Lecture
3:35–4:00	Adjourn / informal networking			

Lunch block (90 min) flow: food served + **Intern Showcase** lightning round while people eat → **Lunch Keynote** as the focused closer → **thank-yous / sponsor recognition / 2028 teaser** fold in at the end of the keynote. (No separate end-of-day closing plenary.)

Throughout the day — exhibits & posters

These run continuously alongside the session grid and use the Gallery and circulation areas, not the four session rooms.

- **Vendor & organization tabling — the Gallery.** Open all day; naturally trafficked during registration (8:00–8:45), every break, and lunch.
- **Poster presentations — throughout the venue.** Displayed all day. Suggest designating **attended poster times** (authors stand by their posters) during the long lunch block and the mid-morning/mid-afternoon breaks so attendees know when to engage.

Two poster/intern pipelines feeding these

1. **Intern projects.** Interns submit their projects for presentation. A selection committee picks **a few for the Intern Showcase lightning talks** (lunch, plenary); the **remaining accepted projects become poster presentations**. One submission pool, two outcomes.
2. **Student poster CFP.** A **separate Call for Proposals for posters from area students** feeds the poster display alongside the intern posters.

Note for the CFP / logistics: both pipelines need submission deadlines, a selection/review step, poster size/format specs, easel or board counts, and assigned display locations. The intern CFP must flag that submitting means *either* a lightning talk *or* a poster.

What this yields

- **2 keynotes** (morning + lunch)
- **1 Intern Showcase** lightning round (plenary, over lunch)
- **14 breakout sessions:**
 - Grand Ballroom: 4 (lecture/panel mix)
 - Terrace A: 4 lectures
 - Terrace B: 4 lectures
 - Grand Ballroom B: 2 workshops (90 min each — one morning, one afternoon)
- **4 concurrent breakout choices** in every block

- **All day:** vendor/organization tabling in the Gallery + poster presentations (intern projects not selected for lightning talks, plus student-CFP posters) throughout the venue

Peak concurrent breakout capacity: $250 + 70 + 100 + 60 = 480$ seats across 4 rooms per block — well above 250 attendance, leaving headroom for popular-session overflow.

Workshop alignment: each 90-min workshop spans both blocks in its half-day and ends exactly when the second lecture block ends, so the grid stays in sync (2 workshops vs. 4 lectures per other room). Workshops run **continuous** through the lecture-room break, with a facilitator-called informal in-room break.

Resolved layout decisions

1. **Ballroom seating: full banquet rounds** all day (max capacity; no seating flip).
2. **Workshops: continuous 90 min** with classroom tables + power and an informal in-room break.
3. **Lunch ordering:** Intern Showcase during eating → Lunch Keynote as closer → thank-yous/extras.
4. **Closing: no separate closing plenary;** recognition folded into the end of the lunch keynote. Morning keynote starts at **9:00**, with extra time built in around lunch.

Remaining venue confirmations

- **Ballroom B (workshops):** confirm laptop/classroom tables, power drops, and AV support for hands-on content.
- **Divider reset:** none required — confirm the divider can simply stay in place all day.
- **Catering timing:** confirm lunch can be served into rounds at the 11:50 transition without disrupting the 12:05 program start.

Alternatives worth considering

- **Panels as an anchor:** schedule the ballroom's larger-draw **panels** opposite the workshops so the two “marquee” formats don't compete for the same audience.
- **5-block dense version:** add a breakout block (~20 sessions) if the call for proposals over-subscribes; trades slack for volume.
- **Uniform-45-min fallback:** if 90-min workshops prove hard to fill, run **45-min** workshops in Ballroom B (4 total) for a fully uniform grid.